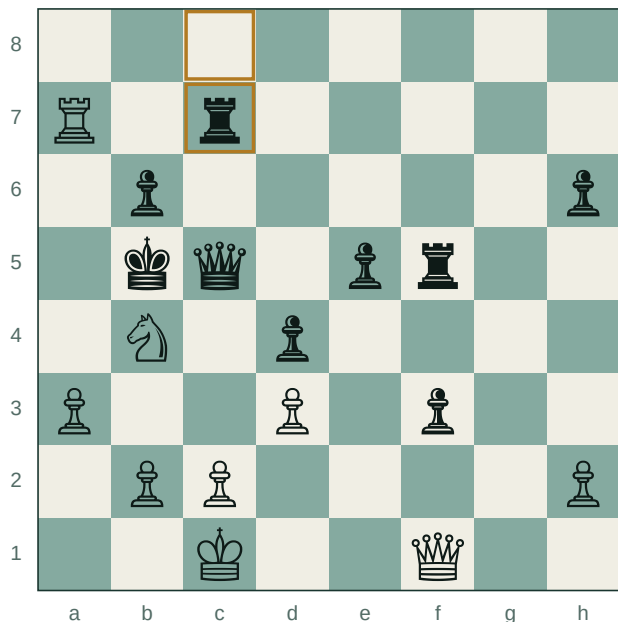


Calculated sacrifices: White, move 37

Calculated sacrifices

White to move



Previous move: 36...Rc7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

37. a4+ Kxb4 38. Qe1+ Qc3 39. bxc3+

37.a4+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **37...Kxb4**.

38.Qe1+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **38...Qc3**.

39.bxc3+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. The move also takes the queen on c3.

At the end, nominal material is White 19 / Black 15 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +6. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +6: the balance goes from -2 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

HOW TO LOOK

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on b5. Geometrically undefended: rook on f5. Check for tactical protection.